

BSN Prerequisite & Application Checklist

Everything you need to get into a nursing program — Nursing School Planner

Use this checklist to stay on track for your BSN application. Requirements vary by school, so always confirm specifics on each program's official admissions page.

1. Prerequisite courses (earn a C or better — many want a B in sciences)

- ☐ Anatomy & Physiology I
- ☐ Anatomy & Physiology II
- ☐ Microbiology
- ☐ General Chemistry
- ☐ Statistics
- ☐ Nutrition
- ☐ Lifespan / Human Development
- ☐ English Composition I

2. GPA targets

- ☐ Cumulative GPA at or above each program's minimum (commonly 2.5–3.0)
- ☐ Science / prerequisite GPA — often weighted most heavily; aim 3.0+
- ☐ Recalculate your GPA after each semester and track it

3. Entrance exam

- ☐ Find out whether your schools require the TEAS, HESI A2, or no exam
- ☐ Register early and study 4–6 weeks (aim well above the minimum)
- ☐ Know each school's minimum score and number of allowed attempts

4. Application materials

- ☐ Official transcripts from every college attended
- ☐ Personal statement / essay (why nursing?)
- ☐ Letters of recommendation (if required)
- ☐ Immunization records, background check, CPR certification (often after acceptance)
- ☐ Note whether the school uses NursingCAS or its own application

5. Deadlines & timeline

- ☐ List each program's application deadline (Fall vs. Spring intake)
- ☐ Mark priority deadlines — often months before the final deadline
- ☐ Build a calendar working backward from the earliest deadline

Next step

See exactly which programs you're a Safe, Match, or Reach for — free at nursingschoolplanner.com/chance-calculator. Compare every BSN program and build your plan at nursingschoolplanner.com.

For planning purposes only — always verify requirements with each school. © Nursing School Planner